



Empathy Mapping

Understanding Users for Better Design Decisions

What is an Empathy Map?

An **Empathy Map** is a visual tool used in UX design to **understand user behaviors, emotions, and pain points.**

It helps designers **build user-centered experiences** by focusing on what users **think, feel, say, and do.**

Why It's Important:

- Helps designers step into the user's shoes.
- Aligns the team's understanding of user needs.
- Improves decision-making in the design process.
- Identifies pain points and opportunities.



When to Use Empathy Mapping?

During User Research

- Helps synthesize insights from interviews & surveys.

Before Ideation

- Guides brainstorming for problem-solving.

During Redesigns

- Understand evolving user behaviors & expectations.

For Stakeholder Alignment

- Creates a shared understanding of user needs.



The Structure of an Empathy Map

An empathy map is divided into four key sections:

- ❶ **SAY** – What the user verbally expresses (quotes, feedback).
- ❷ **THINK** – What the user is thinking but may not say out loud.
- ❸ **DO** – The user's actions, behaviors, and interactions.
- ❹ **FEEL** – The user's emotions, frustrations, and motivations.



How to Create an Empathy Map?

✓ Step 1: Define the User

Identify the target user based on research & personas.

✓ Step 2: Gather Data

Conduct user interviews, observations, and surveys.

✓ Step 3: Fill in the Empathy Map

Use direct user quotes & real insights from research.

✓ Step 4: Identify Patterns & Pain Points

Look for recurring themes to guide UX decisions.

✓ Step 5: Validate & Update

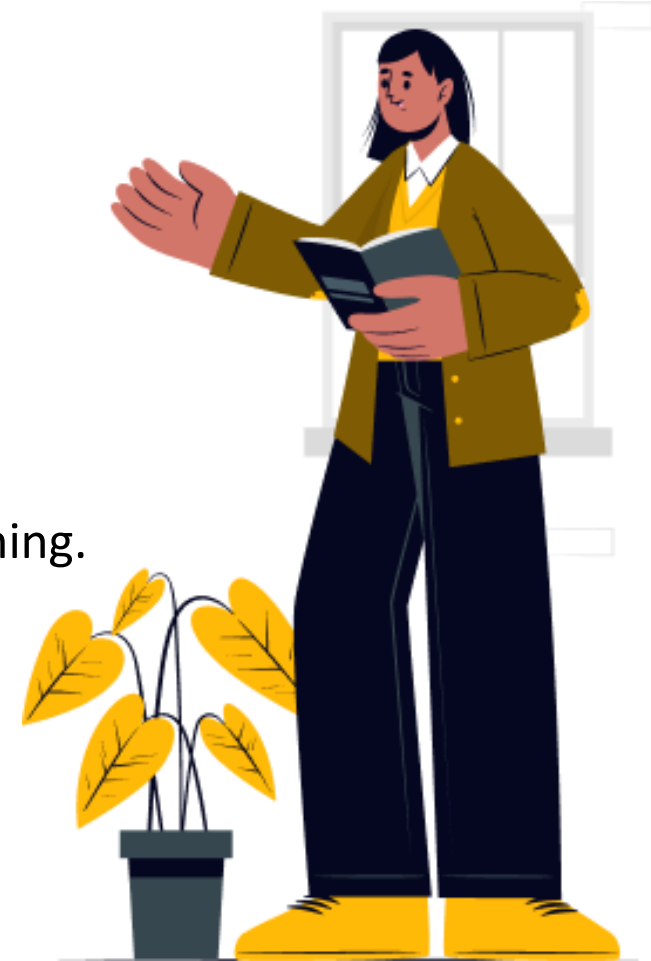
Refine the empathy map based on new data or user testing.



Example of an Empathy Map

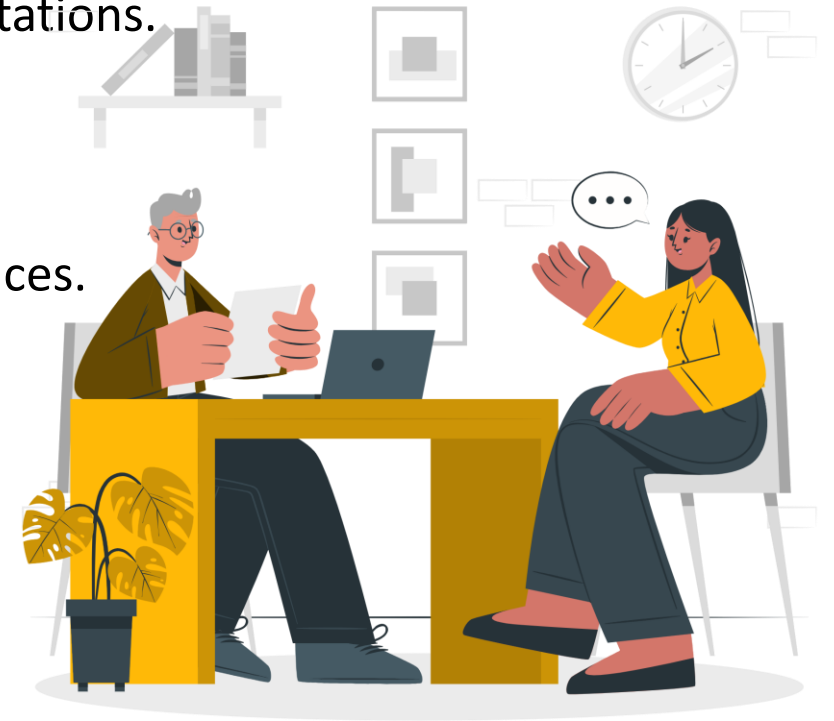
-  **User Persona:** A first-time online banking app user.
-  **Say:** "I'm afraid of making a mistake while transferring money."
-  **Think:** "Is my transaction secure? Will my details be safe?"
-  **Do:** Double-checks transaction details, hesitates before confirming.
-  **Feel:** Anxious, confused, and uncertain.

UX Insight: Improve UI clarity, add confirmation pop-ups, and use trust signals like secure badges.



How Empathy Maps Improve UX Design?

- 🎯 **Improves Product Design:** Ensures the product meets user expectations.
- 🎯 **Enhances Usability:** Reduces friction by addressing pain points.
- 🎯 **Boosts Engagement:** Helps design emotionally resonant experiences.
- 🎯 **Strengthens Team Collaboration:** Aligns designers, developers, and stakeholders.



Best Practices for Effective Empathy Mapping

- ✓ **Base it on real user research, not assumptions.**
- ✓ **Use actual quotes and observations from users.**
- ✓ **Collaborate with your team for diverse perspectives.**
- ✓ **Regularly update the map as user behaviors evolve.**
- ✓ **Keep it simple and easy to understand.**



Why Empathy Mapping is Essential?

🚀 **Empathy Mapping helps designers:**

- ✅ Understand users beyond data & analytics.
- ✅ Create intuitive, frustration-free experiences.
- ✅ Solve real problems by aligning design with emotions.

✨ "Design is not just about how it looks,
but how it makes users feel."





Thank you.